ART

ALL'S FAIR IN ART

ART MUMBAI, A FOUR-DAY ART FAIR DEBUTING THIS NOVEMBER, PROMISES TO BE A VIBRANT ADDITION TO MUMBAI'S ART CALENDAR





FILLING A VOID
Works by (top) Tom Vattakuzhy and (left) G.R. Iranna, which will feature at Art Mumbai

MUMBAI HAS ALWAYS HAD a deep connect with art, and the city's art scene has seen a rather radical revitalisation in recent times. Along with innovative spaces that engender creativity, residencies for artists, vibrant street art, immersive exhibits and the popular Art Night Thursdays by Mumbai Gallery Weekend (a collaborative effort by several of the city's contemporary art galleries), there's another exciting development in the offing... one that will most likely be extremely transformative of not just the city's or country's, but the entire South Asian art ecosystem. The first edition of Art Mumbai will be on at the Mahalaxmi Racecourse's Members' Enclosure between November 16 and 19, 2023.

Art Mumbai will showcase 200 modern and contemporary artworks from 53 galleries, including five from abroad

According to Minal Vazirani, co-founder of auction house Saffronart and one of the leading lights behind Art Mumbai, the four-day art fair will showcase 200 modern and contemporary artworks from 53 galleries from Mumbai, New Delhi, Chennai, and Kolkata, as well as international ones—Grosvenor Gallery from London, Aicon Gallery and Aicon Contemporary from New York, and 1X1 and Volte from Dubai.

Conceptualised by Minal and her husband Dinesh Vazirani, Nakul Dev Chawla (founder and CEO of Global Art Hub), and Conor Macklin, director of London's Grosvenor Gallery, along with a dynamic team, Art Mumbai promises to introduce the international collector to the best contemporary living artists. "For the participating galleries, this is an incredible opportunity to meet and build up clients from an amazing, vibrant city. I believe Art Mumbai will have a profound impact on the South Asian Art market," says Macklin.

Art as an investment has been steadily on the uptick in India. Contemporary art especially is considered inflation-proof, and experts say it has consistently shown high annualised returns. Dinesh points out, "It's important to note the strong growth of the Indian art market, and especially in the last fiscal year, when India's contemporary art market saw its strongest turnover ever, according to a report by Indian Art Investor." It's not surprising then that investors everywhere are clued into platforms such as Art Mumbai. "With the Indian market as vibrant as it is, I'm sure we will see robust sales," observes Harry Hutchison,